



maintaining a flexible way of life. Lepenski Vir in modern-day Serbia was also repeatedly used over many generations and has yielded a lot of information about a culture between two lifestyles. The site, used from as early as 6000 BCE, was situated on the banks of the Danube River, and the group's reliance on fishing was heavy. The fish sculptures found there (see pp.34–35) are significant early works of art and may be symbols of a religious cult, such as the importance of fish to this culture. The people lived in structures whose wide ends faced the river. Revisited for several hundred years, Lepenski Vir provides a portrait of a gradual changeover from nomadic life to more permanent settlement. The seminomadic lifestyle of Lepenski

Vir meant that people lived there for part of the year while also traveling to other areas. Finds at the site discovered some distance away provide the evidence for this.

A continuing way of life

Five thousand years ago, much of East and southern Africa was home to nomadic hunter-gatherer bands, which subsisted on a wide variety of animal and plant foods. Some sites, such as Gwisho in Central Africa, have revealed well-preserved wooden arrowheads and digging sticks, as well as traces of brush shelters. Many of these groups regularly visited rock shelters, including those at Nachikufu in present-day Zambia, Pomongwe in Zimbabwe, and Oakhurst rock shelter

Hunting in the field

A modern San hunter takes aim with bow and arrow. His success depends on meticulous stalking to approach his quarry at close range. Many early hunters used vegetable poisons on their arrows, pursuing wounded animals for hours to kill them before predators struck.

in South Africa. These people, well known for their rock art (see pp.32–33), were the distant ancestors of the modern-day San hunter-gatherers, tiny numbers of whom still live in the Kalahari Desert of Botswana. Modern-day San have long been in contact with farmers, but the ancestry of their culture extends back to ancient times. As in other traditional hunter-gather cultures, the women are responsible for much of the food collection and hunting smaller animals, while the men hunt large prey.

INVENTION

BOW AND ARROW

Bows and arrows appeared during the late Ice Age and came into widespread use by about 10,000 BCE. At first, these would have been simple wooden bows used with stone- or bone-tipped arrows. The composite bow, made of sinews and bone or wood laminated together, is known from 1500 BCE, and reached North America in the first millennium CE.



INUIT BOW

AFTER

Some hunter-gatherer groups had turned to farming by 10,000 BCE. Others continued to develop and innovate.

WHY NOT FARM?

From about 10,000 BCE there was a general transition from the hunter-gatherer lifestyle to farming. Some groups continued to forage for food, perhaps partly due to conditions in the part of the world they lived in, making growing crops or staying in one place impossible. Another reason may be that farming needs **more time spent devoted to food production and carries a greater risk of starvation** if crops fail. Some groups, such as the Haida people of North America and the Aboriginals in Australia, seem to have retained the hunter-gatherer lifestyle.



HAIDA HOUSE

CULTURAL COMPLEXITY

In areas of exceptionally rich food resources, much more **elaborate hunter-gather societies** developed after about 3000 years ago. In the Pacific Northwest of North America, for example, rich salmon and coastal fisheries and abundant lumber led to the development of complex societies under powerful chieftains.

INNOVATION

By 2000 years ago, the Norton people in North America had developed **sophisticated art** styles and an **elaborate harpoon weaponry** for hunting seals. By 1000 CE, the **ancestors of the modern-day Inuit** had settled in Canada.



MODERN INUIT SETTLEMENT